

# UNIVERSITY OF DAR ES SALAAM



COLLEGE OF NATURAL AND APPLIED SCIENCES(CoNAS)

DEPARTMENT OF MATHEMATICS

RESEARCH TITLE: Statistical Analysis of the Awareness and Utilization of Counseling Services among Students at the University of Dar es Salaam.

SUPERVISOR: DR. RASHID MOHAMMED

MEMBERS:

| NAME                   | REG. NO       | PROGRAMME |
|------------------------|---------------|-----------|
| VICTOR THADEI NGATUNGA | 2023-04-10475 | BSMST     |
| AGATHA RICHARD MAGOGE  | 2023-04-06051 | BSMST     |
| ABDALLAH MUSA MNEMWA   | 2023-04-08216 | BSMST     |

## DECLARATION

We, Victor Thadei Ngatunga (Reg. No. 2023-04-10475), Agatha Richard Magoge (Reg. No. 2023-04-06051), and Abdallah Musa Mnemwa (Reg. No. 2023-04-08216), declare that this research report entitled "Statistical Analysis of the Awareness and Utilization of Counselling Services among Students at the University of Dar es Salaam" is our own original work. It has not been submitted to any other university or institution for the award of any degree, diploma, or other academic qualification.

Where the work of other authors has been used, it has been duly acknowledged through citations and references in accordance with academic standards.

**Name:** Victor Thadei Ngatunga

**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Name:** Agatha Richard Magoge

**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Name:** Abdallah Musa Mnemwa

**Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## **CERTIFICATION**

The undersigned certifies that he has read and hereby recommends for acceptance by the University of Dar es Salaam a research report entitled "Statistical Analysis of the Awareness and Utilization of Counseling Services among Students at the University of Dar es Salaam" submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Statistics (BSMST).

### **Supervisor**

Dr. Rashid Mohammed

Signature: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

## **ACKNOWLEDGMENTS**

We express our sincere gratitude to Almighty God for granting us good health, strength, wisdom, and perseverance throughout the completion of this study.

Our heartfelt appreciation goes to our supervisor, Dr. Rashid Mohammed, for his valuable guidance, constructive criticism, patience, and continuous encouragement from the proposal stage to the completion of this research.

We are grateful to the University of Dar es Salaam for providing a conducive learning environment and to all students who voluntarily participated in this study by providing valuable information.

We also extend our sincere appreciation to our lecturers, classmates, friends, and family members for their encouragement, moral support, and assistance throughout this research journey.

Finally, we thank everyone who contributed directly or indirectly to the successful completion of this study.

## ABSTRACT

This study examined the awareness and utilization of counselling services among students at the University of Dar es Salaam. Specifically, the study investigated the relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services, assessed differences in awareness across demographic characteristics, and examined the influence of students' perceptions on counselling service utilization.

A cross-sectional quantitative research design was employed using a convenience sample of 200 students as well as Ms Excel. Data were collected using a structured questionnaire and analysed using R statistical software. Descriptive statistics were used to summarize respondents' characteristics, while Chi-square tests, independent samples t-tests, one-way ANOVA, and logistic regression were employed to examine relationships between variables.

The findings revealed that although 85.5% of respondents were aware of counselling services, only 9.5% had ever utilized them. The association between awareness and utilization was not statistically significant ( $\chi^2 = 4.133$ ,  $p = 0.127$ ). Similarly, no significant differences in awareness were found across gender or year of study. Practical and psychological barriers including lack of time, preference for self-reliance, reliance on friends or family, and concerns about confidentiality were identified as the major factors limiting utilization.

The study concludes that increasing awareness alone is insufficient to improve counselling service utilization. Universities should complement awareness campaigns with interventions that reduce stigma, strengthen confidentiality, improve accessibility, and encourage positive attitudes toward professional counselling.

## Table of Contents

|                                                            |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| UNIVERSITY OF DAR ES SALAAM.....                           | 1  |
| DECLARATION.....                                           | 2  |
| CERTIFICATION.....                                         | 3  |
| ACKNOWLEDGMENTS.....                                       | 4  |
| ABSTRACT.....                                              | 5  |
| LIST OF TABLES.....                                        | 8  |
| LIST OF FIGURES.....                                       | 9  |
| 1. INTRODUCTION.....                                       | 11 |
| 1.1 Background of the Study.....                           | 11 |
| 1.2 Problem Statement.....                                 | 11 |
| 1.3 Objectives of the Study.....                           | 12 |
| 1.3.1 Main Objective.....                                  | 12 |
| 1.3.2 Specific Objectives.....                             | 12 |
| 1.4 Research Questions.....                                | 12 |
| 1.5.1 Scope of the Study.....                              | 12 |
| 1.5.2 Limitations of the Study.....                        | 13 |
| 2.1 Introduction.....                                      | 14 |
| 2.2 Conceptual Review.....                                 | 14 |
| 2.2.1 Awareness of Counseling Services.....                | 14 |
| 2.2.2 Utilization of Counseling Services.....              | 15 |
| 2.2.3 Stigma and Help-Seeking Behavior.....                | 15 |
| 2.2.4 Other Factors Influencing Utilization.....           | 16 |
| 2.3 Empirical Review.....                                  | 16 |
| 2.3.1 Studies on Utilization of Counselling Services.....  | 16 |
| 2.3.2 Studies on Awareness and Help-Seeking Behaviour..... | 17 |
| 2.3.3 Studies on Stigma and Utilization.....               | 18 |
| 2.3.4 Studies on Other Influencing Factors.....            | 18 |
| 2.4 Synthesis and Relevance to the Current Study.....      | 19 |
| 3. METHODOLOGY.....                                        | 20 |
| 3.1 Introduction.....                                      | 20 |
| 3.2 Research Design.....                                   | 20 |
| 3.3 Study Area.....                                        | 20 |
| 3.4 Target Population.....                                 | 21 |
| 3.5 Sample Size and Sampling Technique.....                | 21 |
| 3.5.1 Sample Size.....                                     | 21 |
| 3.5.2 Sampling Technique.....                              | 21 |
| 3.6 Data Collection Methods.....                           | 22 |
| 3.6.1 Primary Data Collection.....                         | 22 |
| 3.6.2 Data Collection Procedure.....                       | 22 |
| 3.7 Measurement of Variables.....                          | 22 |
| 3.7.1 Dependent Variable.....                              | 22 |
| 3.7.2 Independent Variables.....                           | 23 |
| (a) Awareness of Counselling Services.....                 | 23 |
| (b) Perceived Stigma.....                                  | 23 |
| (c) Demographic Variables.....                             | 23 |
| 3.8 Data Analysis Plan.....                                | 23 |

|                                                                                 |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 3.8.1 Data Coding and Preparation.....                                          | 23 |
| 3.8.2 Descriptive Analysis.....                                                 | 24 |
| 3.8.3 Inferential Analysis.....                                                 | 24 |
| 4.DATA ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION OF FINDINGS.....                                 | 25 |
| 4.1 Introduction.....                                                           | 25 |
| 4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents.....                             | 25 |
| 4.3 Descriptive Statistics on Awareness and Utilization.....                    | 26 |
| 4.4 Relationship Between Awareness and Utilization of Counselling Services..... | 27 |
| 4.5 Differences in Awareness Across Demographic Characteristics.....            | 28 |
| 4.6 Effect of Perceptions and Other Factors on Utilization.....                 | 30 |
| 4.7 Discussion of Findings.....                                                 | 32 |
| 4.8 Chapter Summary.....                                                        | 33 |
| 5.2 Conclusion.....                                                             | 34 |
| 5.3 Recommendations.....                                                        | 35 |
| 5.3.1 Recommendations to the University of Dar es Salaam.....                   | 35 |
| 5.3.2 Recommendations to Counseling Service Providers.....                      | 35 |
| 5.3.3 Recommendations to Students.....                                          | 35 |
| 5.4 Recommendations for Future Research.....                                    | 36 |
| 5.5 Chapter Summary.....                                                        | 36 |
| RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE.....                                                     | 39 |
| Introduction.....                                                               | 39 |
| SECTION B: AWARENESS OF COUNSELLING SERVICES.....                               | 40 |
| SECTION C: UTILIZATION OF COUNSELLING SERVICES.....                             | 40 |
| If YES, answer Questions 2 and 3.....                                           | 40 |
| SECTION D: BARRIERS TO UTILIZATION.....                                         | 41 |
| SECTION E: PERCEPTIONS TOWARD COUNSELLING SERVICES.....                         | 41 |
| Thank You.....                                                                  | 42 |

## LIST OF TABLES

|                                                                                    |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Table 4.1 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents.....                          | 19 |
| Table 4.2 Descriptive Summary of Awareness and Utilization.....                    | 21 |
| Table 4.3 Chi-Square Test of Awareness Level by Utilization.....                   | 22 |
| Table 4.4 Mean Awareness Score by Gender and Year of Study.....                    | 24 |
| Table 4.5 Reported Barriers to Utilization Among Non-users.....                    | 26 |
| Table 4.6 Logistic Regression of Utilization on Awareness<br>Score and Gender..... | 28 |



**LIST OF FIGURES**

Figure 4.1 Utilization Rate of Counselling Services by  
Awareness Level.....23

Figure 4.2 Distribution of Awareness Score by Gender  
and Year of Study.....25

Figure 4.3 Reported Barriers to Utilization Among Non-users.....27

## LIST OF ABBREVIATION

| Abbreviation | Meaning                                               |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| ANOVA        | Analysis of Variance                                  |
| BSMST        | Bachelor of Science in Mathematical Statistics        |
| CoNAS        | College of Natural and Applied Sciences               |
| COAF         | College of Agriculture and Food Technology            |
| COET         | College of Engineering and Technology                 |
| COICT        | College of Information and Communication Technologies |
| COSS         | College of Social Sciences                            |
| OR           | Odds Ratio                                            |
| R            | R Statistical Software                                |
| SD           | Standard Deviation                                    |
| UDBS         | University of Dar es Salaam Business School           |
| UDSM         | University of Dar es Salaam                           |
| UDSE         | University of Dar es Salaam School of Economics       |
| WHO          | World Health Organization                             |

## **1. INTRODUCTION**

### **1.1 Background of the Study**

Counseling services are an essential component of student support systems in higher learning institutions. They are designed to assist students in coping with academic challenges, personal issues, and psychological difficulties that may affect their academic performance and overall well-being. Globally, there has been an increasing recognition of the importance of counselling services in promoting mental health and enhancing students' success in universities.

University students often face multiple stressors, including academic pressure, financial constraints, social adjustments, and career uncertainties. These challenges may lead to emotional distress, anxiety, and other mental health concerns, which require professional support. Counseling services provide a structured and confidential environment where students can seek guidance and develop coping strategies.

At University of Dar es Salaam, counseling services are available to support students in addressing various academic, social, and psychological issues. Despite the availability of these services, there is concern that many students do not fully utilize them. This situation raises questions about whether students are sufficiently aware of the existence and benefits of counselling services, and whether other factors influence their willingness to seek help.

Awareness is a critical factor in the utilization of counseling services. Students who are not aware of the availability, accessibility, or benefits of such services are unlikely to use them. However, awareness alone may not guarantee utilization, as perceptions such as stigma, trust, and accessibility also play an important role in influencing students' decisions.

### **1.2 Problem Statement**

Despite the availability of counseling services at University of Dar es Salaam, there is evidence that many undergraduate students do not utilize these services effectively. This underutilization persists even though students face increasing academic, social, and psychological challenges that may require professional support.

One of the key issues contributing to this problem is the lack of clear empirical evidence on students' level of awareness of counselling services and how such awareness influences their

utilization. In addition, factors such as stigma, lack of trust in confidentiality, limited accessibility, and cultural perceptions may discourage students from seeking counselling services.

Most existing studies focus on general discussions of student mental health and counselling services without establishing a clear statistical relationship between awareness and utilization. As a result, university administrators and policymakers may lack sufficient evidence to design targeted interventions aimed at improving the uptake of counseling services.

Therefore, there is a need for a systematic and statistical analysis of the awareness and utilization of counseling services among undergraduate students in order to provide evidence-based recommendations for improving student support systems.

### **1.3 Objectives of the Study**

#### **1.3.1 Main Objective**

To statistically analyze the awareness and utilization of counseling services among students at University of Dar es Salaam.

#### **1.3.2 Specific Objectives**

1. To examine the relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services.
2. To assess differences in awareness of counseling services across demographic characteristics such as gender and year of study.
3. To evaluate the effect of students' perceptions, including stigma, confidentiality, and accessibility, on the utilization of counseling services.

### **1.4 Research Questions**

1. Is there a significant relationship between awareness and utilization of counseling services among students?
2. Are there significant differences in awareness of counseling services across demographic characteristics such as gender and year of study?
3. How do students' perceptions, including stigma, confidentiality, and accessibility, affect the utilization of counseling services?

### **1.5 Scope and Limitations of the Study**

### **1.5.1 Scope of the Study**

This study focuses on all students at University of Dar es Salaam. It examines their level of awareness and utilization of counselling services, as well as the factors influencing their decisions to use or not use such services. The study is limited to counselling services offered within the university and does not consider external counselling services.

### **1.5.2 Limitations of the Study**

This study may be subject to several limitations. First, the use of self-reported data may introduce response bias, as participants may not always provide accurate or honest responses. Second, the study is conducted within a single institution, which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other universities. Third, time and resource constraints may restrict the sample size and depth of analysis. Despite these limitations, appropriate measures will be taken to ensure the reliability and validity of the findings.

## **2. LITERATURE REVIEW**

### **2.1 Introduction**

This chapter presents a comprehensive review of literature related to the awareness and utilization of counseling services among university students. It examines key concepts, empirical studies, and theoretical perspectives that explain students' help seeking behavior. The chapter is organized into conceptual review, empirical review, theoretical framework, and conceptual framework. It also highlights the research gap that the current study seeks to address.

### **2.2 Conceptual Review**

According to WHO (2022), approximately one in eight people worldwide live with a mental disorder. University students are particularly vulnerable due to academic and social pressures. Despite the availability of counselling services, studies have reported low utilization rates among students (Eisenberg et al., 2007; Auerbach et al., 2016).

#### **2.2.1 Awareness of Counseling Services**

Awareness of counseling services refers to the extent to which students have knowledge about the existence, accessibility, location, and benefits of counselling services within their institution. It also includes understanding how to access such services and the types of problems they address.

Awareness is closely related to the concept of mental health literacy, which involves the ability to recognize mental health issues and knowledge of available support systems. Studies have shown that higher levels of awareness significantly increase the likelihood of help-seeking behavior among students. For instance, Reavley et al. (2012) found that students with greater mental health literacy were more likely to identify psychological problems and seek appropriate support.

However, awareness alone does not necessarily lead to utilization. Gulliver et al. (2010) argue that although awareness is a necessary condition for help-seeking, it is not sufficient, as other psychological and social barriers may prevent students from using counselling services. This suggests that awareness must be considered alongside other influencing factors such as attitudes and perceptions.

Furthermore, inadequate dissemination of information about counselling services within universities can significantly reduce awareness levels. Many students may not be exposed to sufficient

information about available services during orientation or through institutional communication channels, leading to under-utilization.

### **2.2.2 Utilization of Counseling Services**

Utilization of counseling services refers to the actual use of these services by students when they encounter academic, personal, or psychological challenges. It is commonly measured by whether students have accessed counseling services and the frequency of such use.

Despite the increasing prevalence of mental health issues among university students, utilization rates remain low. Eisenberg et al. (2007) found that although a significant proportion of students reported experiencing mental health problems, only a small percentage sought professional help. Similarly, Auerbach et al. (2016) reported that many students with diagnosable mental health conditions do not receive adequate treatment.

This gap between need and utilization indicates that the mere availability of counselling services does not guarantee their use. Structural, psychological, and social barriers often prevent students from seeking help. As a result, universities must go beyond providing services and focus on understanding the factors that influence utilization.

### **2.2.3 Stigma and Help-Seeking Behavior**

Stigma is one of the most significant barriers to the utilization of counseling services. It refers to negative beliefs, attitudes, and stereotypes associated with seeking psychological help.

Corrigan (2004) explains that stigma can lead to discrimination and social exclusion, discouraging individuals from seeking help. In the context of university students, stigma may manifest as fear of being labeled as weak, unstable, or incapable. This fear can significantly reduce students' willingness to access counseling services.

Stigma can be categorized into public stigma and self stigma. Public stigma refers to societal attitudes towards individuals who seek mental health support, while self-stigma involves internalized negative beliefs that discourage help seeking. Eisenberg et al. (2009) found that students with higher levels of perceived stigma were less likely to seek counseling services.

Addressing stigma is therefore essential in improving utilization rates. Universities must create supportive environments that normalize help seeking behavior and reduce negative perceptions associated with counseling.

#### **2.2.4 Other Factors Influencing Utilization**

In addition to awareness and stigma, several other factors influence students' utilization of counseling services.

- a) Confidentiality is a critical factor, as students are more likely to seek help if they trust that their personal information will be kept private. Concerns about confidentiality can deter students from using counseling services, particularly in close-knit academic environments.
- b) Accessibility also plays a significant role. Factors such as the location of counseling offices, availability of appointments, and ease of access can influence utilization. If services are perceived as difficult to access, students may be discouraged from seeking help.
- c) Perceived need is another important determinant. Students must recognize that they require professional support before they can seek counselling services. Without this recognition, even high levels of awareness may not lead to utilization.

### **2.3 Empirical Review**

#### **2.3.1 Studies on Utilization of Counselling Services**

Research has consistently shown that university students experience substantial psychological, academic, and social challenges, yet the utilization of professional counselling services remains relatively low.

Eisenberg et al. (2007) found that although many university students reported experiencing mental health problems, only a small proportion sought professional counselling services. The study identified barriers such as perceived stigma, lack of perceived need, and limited awareness of available services. Similarly, Auerbach et al. (2016), in a large international study involving university students from several countries, reported that many students with mental health disorders did not receive professional treatment despite the availability of support services.

Evidence from Africa indicates a similar trend. Karimi (2016), in a study conducted in Kenyan universities, found that the majority of students did not utilize counselling services despite the existence of counseling units within their institutions. The study recommended increased sensitization and awareness programmes to encourage students to seek professional support. Furthermore, Lasode, Lawal and Ofodile (2021) found that although Nigerian university students



were generally aware of guidance and counselling services, actual utilization remained relatively low due to misconceptions and negative perceptions regarding counseling services.

In Tanzania, Kalonge (2007) examined the provision of counseling services at the University of Dar es Salaam and found that students faced a variety of counseling needs related to academics, finances, relationships, and career development. However, utilization of available services was affected by institutional and individual factors. More recently, Otieno and Simiyu (2020) observed that counselling services in Tanzanian universities were often underutilized due to inadequate awareness, limited resources, and insufficient institutional support.

These studies suggest that the under utilization of counseling services remains a significant challenge across different university settings despite growing student support needs.

### **2.3.2 Studies on Awareness and Help-Seeking Behaviour**

Awareness of counselling services plays an important role in determining whether students seek professional assistance when faced with academic, emotional, or psychological difficulties.

Reavley et al. (2012) found that students with higher levels of mental health literacy were more likely to recognize symptoms of psychological distress and seek appropriate support services. Similarly, Jorm et al. (2000) argued that knowledge of mental health problems and available interventions is a prerequisite for effective help-seeking behavior.

In Nigeria, Lasode et al. (2021) reported that awareness of counseling services among university students was relatively high, although awareness did not always translate into actual utilization. The authors concluded that positive perceptions of counseling services were necessary for awareness to influence help seeking behavior.

Within the Tanzanian context, Otieno and Simiyu (2020) reported that many students were not adequately informed about the existence, location, and benefits of counseling services available in their universities. The study emphasized the importance of orientation programmes and awareness campaigns in increasing students' willingness to seek counseling services. Similarly, Rushahu (2023) found that students in higher learning institutions expressed a need for more accessible counseling services and emphasized the importance of awareness in improving service uptake.

These findings suggest that awareness is an important but insufficient condition for counseling service utilization, as other barriers may still prevent students from seeking professional help.

### **2.3.3 Studies on Stigma and Utilization**

Stigma is widely recognized as one of the most significant barriers to help-seeking behaviour among university students.

Corrigan (2004) argued that stigma creates fear of discrimination and negative social judgement, discouraging individuals from seeking professional psychological assistance. Similarly, Eisenberg et al. (2009) found that students who perceived greater stigma associated with mental health services were significantly less likely to seek counselling.

Gulliver et al. (2010), in a systematic review of barriers to help-seeking among young people, identified stigma as one of the most frequently reported obstacles to counselling utilization. Students often feared being perceived as weak or incapable if they sought professional support.

In Tanzania, Otieno and Simiyu (2020) reported that students frequently associated counselling services with severe personal problems, leading to reluctance in seeking assistance. Qualitative evidence from Tanzanian university students also suggests that cultural attitudes and misconceptions surrounding mental health may discourage help-seeking behaviour and reinforce reliance on informal support systems.

The literature therefore indicates that stigma remains a major challenge that universities must address in order to improve counselling service utilization.

### **2.3.4 Studies on Other Influencing Factors**

Apart from awareness and stigma, several other factors have been found to influence students' utilization of counselling services.

Gulliver et al. (2010) reported that many students preferred seeking support from friends, family members, or religious leaders rather than professional counsellors. Similarly, Rickwood et al. (2005) observed that informal help-seeking behaviours often precede professional help-seeking among young adults.

Accessibility is another important determinant of utilization. Eisenberg et al. (2007) found that service location, appointment availability, and waiting times influenced students' decisions to seek professional support. Students were less likely to use counselling services when access procedures were perceived as inconvenient.

In Tanzania, Rushahu (2023) found that students viewed online counselling as a potential solution to barriers related to accessibility, privacy, and convenience. Participants reported that online counselling could improve access to psychosocial support while maintaining confidentiality. Likewise, Otieno and Simiyu (2020) identified inadequate funding, shortage of trained counsellors, and poor dissemination of information as major obstacles to effective counselling service delivery in Tanzanian universities.

Confidentiality has also been identified as a critical factor affecting utilization. Students are more likely to seek counselling services when they trust that personal information will remain private. Concerns regarding confidentiality may therefore discourage students from utilizing available counselling services.

## **2.4 Synthesis and Relevance to the Current Study**

The reviewed studies provide important insights into the awareness and utilization of counselling services among university students. However, several gaps remain.

First, most studies are conducted in developed countries, with limited evidence from developing country contexts, particularly Tanzania. This raises questions about the applicability of existing findings to local settings such as University of Dar es Salaam.

Second, many studies focus on individual factors such as stigma or awareness in isolation, without examining their combined effect on utilization. There is a need for studies that analyze the interaction between multiple factors.

Third, some studies rely primarily on descriptive analysis and do not apply advanced statistical methods to establish relationships between variables. This limits the ability to identify significant predictors of utilization.

Therefore, this study seeks to address these gaps by providing a statistical analysis of the relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services and identifying key factors influencing students' help-seeking behavior within the context of the University of Dar es Salaam.

### **3. METHODOLOGY**

#### **3.1 Introduction**

This chapter presents the methodology employed in this study. It describes the research design, study area, target population, sampling procedures, data collection methods, measurement of variables, and data analysis techniques used to examine the awareness and utilization of counselling services among undergraduate students at University of Dar es Salaam. The chapter also outlines the validity and reliability of the research instrument as well as ethical considerations observed during the study.

#### **3.2 Research Design**

This study employed a cross-sectional quantitative research design, whereby data were collected from respondents at a single point in time. This design is appropriate for studies that aim to describe characteristics of a population and examine relationships between variables without manipulating them.

The choice of a quantitative approach is justified by the nature of the study, which seeks to measure levels of awareness and utilization of counselling services and to analyze relationships between variables using statistical techniques. The cross-sectional design allows for efficient data collection within a limited timeframe and provides a snapshot of the current situation regarding students' awareness and utilization of counselling services.

Furthermore, the design is suitable for applying inferential statistical methods such as association tests and regression analysis, which are essential for testing the study hypotheses and identifying factors influencing utilization.

#### **3.3 Study Area**

The study was conducted at University of Dar es Salaam, one of the leading higher learning institutions in Tanzania. The university hosts a large and diverse population of undergraduate students enrolled in various academic programs across multiple colleges and schools.

The selection of this study area is appropriate because the university provides counselling services aimed at supporting students' academic, social, and psychological well-being. Additionally, the diversity of the student population makes it a suitable setting for examining variations in awareness and utilization of counselling services.

### **3.4 Target Population**

The target population for this study comprises all students enrolled at University of Dar es Salaam, including both undergraduate and postgraduate students.

This population is considered appropriate because counselling services at the university are available to all students, and mental health and help-seeking behavior may vary across different academic levels. Including both undergraduate and postgraduate students allows for a broader understanding of awareness and utilization patterns within the university context.

### **3.5 Sample Size and Sampling Technique**

#### **3.5.1 Sample Size**

We will use Cochran's Formula:  $n = (Z^2 * p * (1-p)) / (e^2)$ , with  $Z=1.96$  for 95%,  $p=0.5$  and  $e=0.05$  gives us 385 samples. However, this study will use a sample size of at least 100 students from University of Dar es Salaam.

The choice of this sample size was guided by practical considerations such as time and resource constraints, while still being sufficient to allow for meaningful statistical analysis. A sample of 100 respondents is adequate for applying basic descriptive and inferential statistical techniques, including the Chi-Square Test of Independence and Logistic Regression, provided that the data meet the required assumptions.

#### **3.5.2 Sampling Technique**

The study will use a convenience sampling technique to select respondents from undergraduate students at University of Dar es Salaam.

Under this approach, respondents will be selected based on their availability and willingness to participate in the study. This method was considered appropriate due to practical constraints such as limited time and resources, as well as the absence of a complete sampling frame for all undergraduate students.

Convenience sampling allows efficient data collection within the study period and facilitated access to a sufficient number of respondents. Although this method may limit the generalizability of the findings, it is commonly used in exploratory and cross-sectional studies where the primary objective is to identify patterns and relationships among variables.

### **3.6 Data Collection Methods**

#### **3.6.1 Primary Data Collection**

This study relied on primary data collected from undergraduate students at University of Dar es Salaam. Primary data were obtained using a structured questionnaire designed in line with the objectives of the study.

The questionnaire consisted of closed-ended questions to facilitate quantitative analysis. It was divided into sections covering demographic characteristics, awareness of counselling services, utilization of counselling services, and students' perceptions, including stigma, confidentiality, and accessibility. Likert scale items were used to measure awareness and perception variables, allowing for the computation of composite scores.

The use of a structured questionnaire ensured uniformity in responses and enabled the application of statistical techniques for analysis.

#### **3.6.2 Data Collection Procedure**

Data will be collected by administering the questionnaire to selected respondents using a convenience sampling approach. The questionnaires will be distributed electronically, due to limitations in funds.

Before administering the questionnaire, respondents will be informed about the purpose of the study and assured that their responses would remain confidential. Participation was voluntary, and respondents were given adequate time to complete the questionnaire.

### **3.7 Measurement of Variables**

This study involved both dependent and independent variables measured using structured questionnaire items.

#### **3.7.1 Dependent Variable**

The dependent variable is utilization of counselling services, which represents whether a student has ever used counselling services at University of Dar es Salaam.

It will be measured as a binary variable, this binary classification allows the use of categorical data analysis techniques such as the Chi-Square Test of Independence and Logistic Regression.

### **3.7.2 Independent Variables**

#### **(a) Awareness of Counselling Services**

Awareness will be measured using a set of Likert-scale items assessing students' knowledge of counselling services, including availability, location, access procedures, and services offered.

Each item was rated on a 5 point scale:

1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Neutral, 4 = Agree, 5 = Strongly Agree

The responses were aggregated to form a composite awareness score, where higher scores indicate higher levels of awareness. For analysis purposes, the awareness score will be treated as both: a continuous variable (for t-test, ANOVA, regression), and a categorical variable (low, moderate, high awareness) where necessary.

#### **(b) Perceived Stigma**

Stigma will be measured using Likert-scale statements assessing students' perceptions of negative social judgment associated with using counseling services. Higher scores indicate higher perceived stigma.

#### **(c) Demographic Variables**

The study also included categorical demographic variables such as: Gender, Age group and Year of study. These will be used for group comparisons and association tests.

### **3.8 Data Analysis Plan.**

Data collected from the study will be coded, cleaned, and analyzed using R statistical software and MS excel. The analysis will focus on describing patterns of awareness and utilization of counselling services among students at University of Dar es Salaam and examining relationships between variables.

#### **3.8.1 Data Coding and Preparation**

After data collection, responses will be coded and entered into R and MS Excel for analysis. The coding scheme will be as follows:

- Utilization of counselling services: 1 = Yes, 0 = No
- Likert-scale variables (awareness, stigma, confidentiality, accessibility): 1–5 scale
- Categorical variables (gender, year of study): will be converted into factor variables

Data cleaning will be conducted to check for missing values, inconsistencies, and outliers before analysis.

### **3.8.2 Descriptive Analysis**

Descriptive statistics will be used to summarize the characteristics of respondents and the distribution of key variables. The analysis will include: Frequencies and percentages for categorical variables, Means and standard deviations for continuous and Likert-scale variables. These results will provide an overview of awareness levels and utilization patterns among students.

### **3.8.3 Inferential Analysis**

To examine relationships between variables, inferential statistical techniques will be applied.

The Chi-Square Test of Independence will be used to assess associations between categorical variables such as awareness level and utilization of counseling services.

The Independent Samples t-test and Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) will be used to compare mean awareness scores across demographic groups such as gender and year of study.

To identify factors influencing utilization of counseling services, a Logistic Regression model will be applied. The model will estimate the probability of a student utilizing counselling services based on awareness, stigma, confidentiality, accessibility, and demographic factors.



## 4.DATA ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION OF FINDINGS

### 4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the results of the statistical analysis of data collected on the awareness and utilization of counselling services among students at the University of Dar es Salaam. Data were analyzed in R (version 4.3) using the dplyr and ggplot2 packages. The chapter begins with the demographic profile of respondents, followed by descriptive statistics on awareness and utilization, and then inferential analysis organized around the three research questions of the study: (i) the relationship between awareness and utilization, (ii) demographic differences in awareness, and (iii) the effect of perceptions and other factors on utilization. A discussion linking the findings to the reviewed literature concludes the chapter.

### 4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

A total of 200 students participated in the study. Table 4.1 summarizes their demographic characteristics in terms of gender, age group, year of study, and college.

**Table 4.1**

Demographic Characteristics of Respondents (N = 200)

| Variable      | Category             | n   | Percent (%) |
|---------------|----------------------|-----|-------------|
| Gender        | Female               | 57  | 28.5        |
|               | Male                 | 143 | 71.5        |
| Age group     | Below 20             | 3   | 1.5         |
|               | Between 20 and 24    | 188 | 94          |
|               | Above 24             | 9   | 4.5         |
| Year of study | First year           | 2   | 1           |
|               | Second year          | 20  | 10          |
|               | Third year           | 161 | 80.5        |
|               | Fourth year or above | 17  | 8.5         |
| College       | CoNAS                | 89  | 44.5        |
|               | COET                 | 35  | 17.5        |
|               | UDBS                 | 31  | 15.5        |
|               | COICT                | 20  | 10          |
|               | UDSE                 | 11  | 5.5         |
|               | COSS                 | 9   | 4.5         |

|      |   |     |
|------|---|-----|
| COAF | 5 | 2.5 |
|------|---|-----|

Source: Survey data, 2026 ( $n = 200$ ).

The sample was predominantly male (71.5%) and concentrated in the 20-24 age bracket (94.0%) and the third year of study (80.5%), reflecting the convenience sampling procedure used. Respondents were drawn from all seven colleges, with the College of Natural and Applied Sciences (CoNAS) contributing the largest share (44.5%). These patterns should be borne in mind when generalizing the findings, since the sample is not proportionally representative of the wider student population.

### 4.3 Descriptive Statistics on Awareness and Utilization

Awareness of counselling services was measured using five Likert-scale items (general awareness rating, understanding of the types of services, knowledge of benefits, perceived accessibility of information, and perception of university promotion of the service), aggregated into a composite Awareness Score ranging from 1 to 5. Utilization was measured as a binary variable indicating whether a student had ever used counselling services.

**Table 4.2: Descriptive Summary of Awareness and Utilization**

| Indicator                          | Category | n   | Percent (%) |
|------------------------------------|----------|-----|-------------|
| Ever heard of counselling services | Yes      | 171 | 85.5        |
|                                    | No       | 29  | 14.5        |
| Awareness level (composite score)  | Low      | 72  | 36          |
|                                    | Moderate | 62  | 31          |
|                                    | High     | 66  | 33          |
| Ever used counselling services     | Yes      | 19  | 9.5         |
|                                    | No       | 181 | 90.5        |

Mean Awareness Score = 3.23 (SD = 0.51), on a scale of 1-5. Awareness levels were formed by splitting the composite score into tertiles (Low  $\leq 3.0$ , Moderate 3.0-3.4, High  $> 3.4$ ).

The results show a marked gap between awareness and utilization: while the great majority of students (85.5%) reported having heard of counselling services and the mean composite awareness

score (3.23 out of 5) indicates a moderate level of awareness, only 9.5% of respondents had ever used the service. This gap mirrors the pattern reported in earlier studies (Eisenberg et al., 2007; Otieno & Simiyu, 2020), in which availability and awareness of counselling services did not translate into proportional uptake.

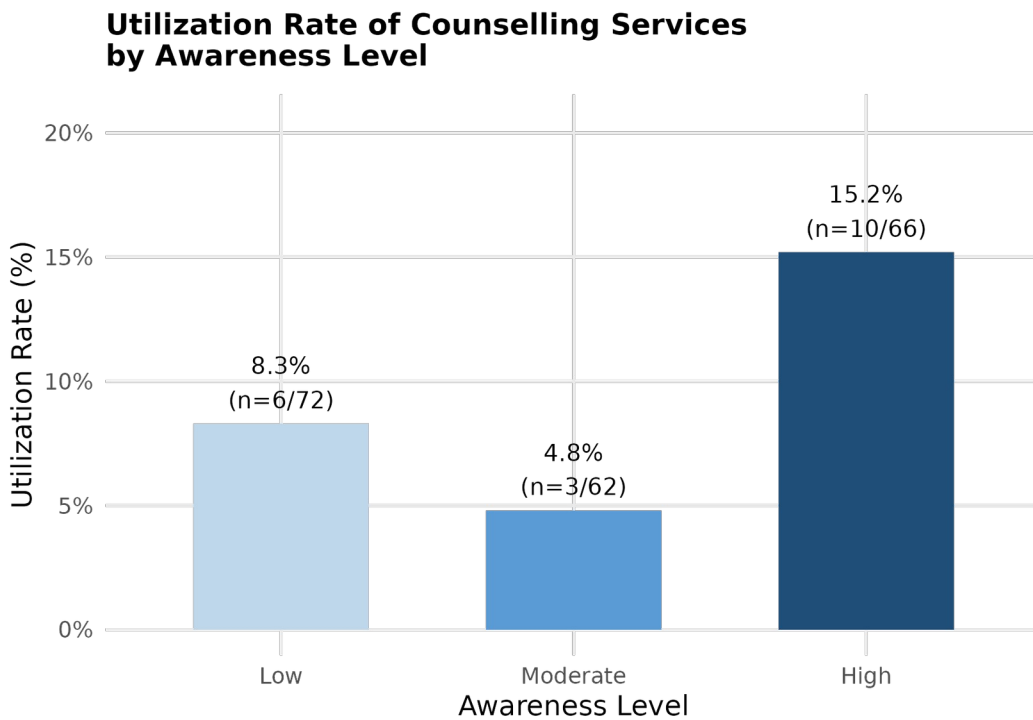
#### 4.4 Relationship Between Awareness and Utilization of Counselling Services

This section addresses the first research question: “Is there a significant relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services among students?” A Chi-square test of independence was conducted between the categorical Awareness Level (Low, Moderate, High) and Utilization status (Yes/No).

**Table 4.3: Chi-Square Test of Awareness Level by Utilization Status**

| Awareness Level | Did Not Use (No) | Used (Yes) | Total | Utilization Rate (%) |
|-----------------|------------------|------------|-------|----------------------|
| Low             | 66               | 6          | 72    | 8.3                  |
| Moderate        | 59               | 3          | 62    | 4.8                  |
| High            | 56               | 10         | 66    | 15.2                 |
| Total           | 181              | 19         | 200   | 9.5                  |

$\chi^2(2) = 4.133$ ,  $p = 0.127$  (not significant at  $\alpha = 0.05$ ). A supplementary simple logistic regression of utilization on the continuous Awareness Score yielded an odds ratio of 1.17 per 1-point increase ( $p = 0.744$ ), confirming the absence of a statistically significant association.



**Figure 4.1: Utilization Rate of Counselling Services by Awareness Level**

Although utilization is numerically highest among students with high awareness (15.2%) compared with those with low (8.3%) or moderate (4.8%) awareness, the Chi-square test did not reach statistical significance ( $p = 0.127$ ). The odds ratio from the logistic model ( $OR = 1.17$ ) further suggests only a small, statistically non-significant increase in the likelihood of utilization per unit increase in awareness score. This indicates that, in this sample, awareness alone is not a statistically sufficient predictor of utilization, which is consistent with Gulliver et al. (2010) and Lasode et al. (2021), who argued that awareness is a necessary but not sufficient condition for help-seeking behavior. A plausible explanation is that the very small number of students who had ever used the service ( $n = 19$ ) limited the statistical power of the test; a larger, probability-based sample would be needed to detect a moderate-sized association with confidence.

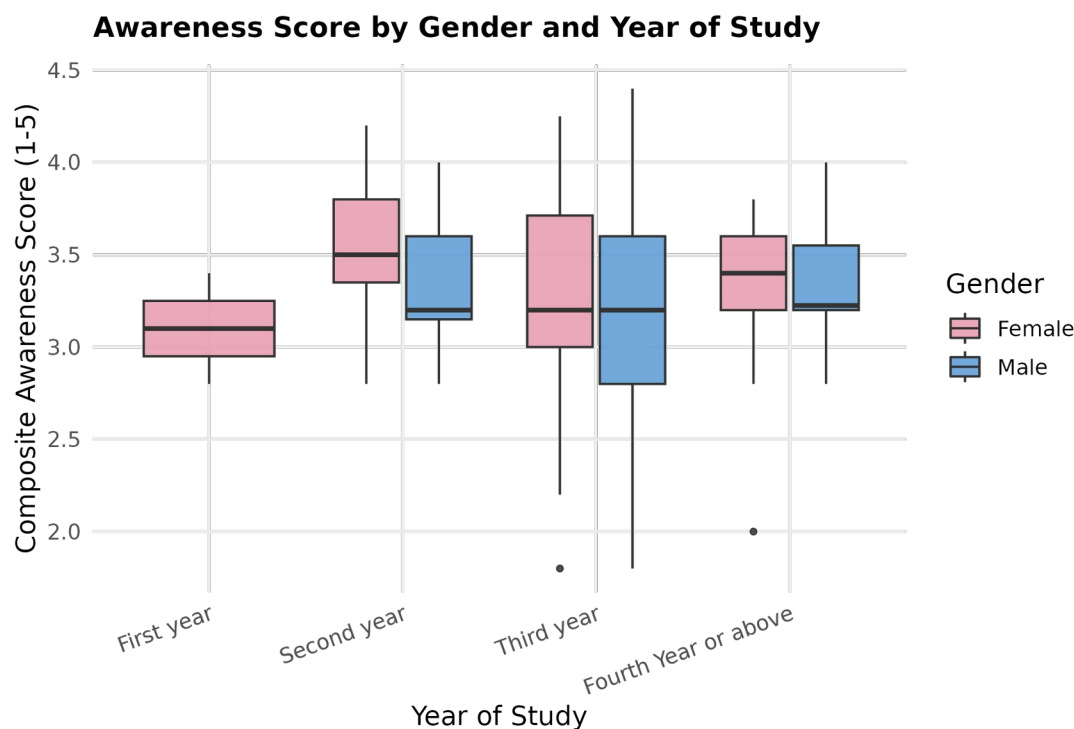
#### 4.5 Differences in Awareness Across Demographic Characteristics

The second research question asked: “Are there significant differences in awareness of counseling services across demographic characteristics such as gender and year of study?” An independent-samples t-test was used to compare mean Awareness Scores between male and female students, and a one-way ANOVA was used to compare mean Awareness Scores across the four years of study.

**Table 4.4**

### Mean Awareness Score by Gender and Year of Study

| Grouping Variable | Category             | n   | Mean | SD   | Test Statistic    | p-value |
|-------------------|----------------------|-----|------|------|-------------------|---------|
| Gender            | Female               | 57  | 3.29 | 0.53 | $t(99.6) = 1.10$  | 0.27    |
|                   | Male                 | 143 | 3.2  | 0.51 |                   |         |
| Year of study     | First year           | 2   | 3.1  | 0.42 | $F(3,196) = 1.14$ | 0.34    |
|                   | Second year          | 20  | 3.41 | 0.38 |                   |         |
|                   | Third year           | 161 | 3.2  | 0.53 |                   |         |
|                   | Fourth year or above | 17  | 3.31 | 0.48 |                   |         |



**Figure 4.2: Distribution of Awareness Score by Gender and Year of Study**

The t-test showed that female students reported a marginally higher mean awareness score ( $M = 3.29$ ,  $SD = 0.53$ ) than male students ( $M = 3.20$ ,  $SD = 0.51$ ), but the difference was not statistically significant,  $t(99.6) = 1.10$ ,  $p = 0.272$ . Similarly, the one-way ANOVA revealed no statistically significant difference in mean awareness scores across the four years of study,  $F(3, 196) = 1.14$ ,  $p = 0.335$ , although second-year students had the numerically highest mean score ( $M = 3.41$ ). These results indicate that, within this sample, awareness of counselling services is fairly homogeneous across gender and academic year, suggesting that any awareness-raising interventions need not be narrowly targeted by these demographic characteristics but should instead be applied university-wide.

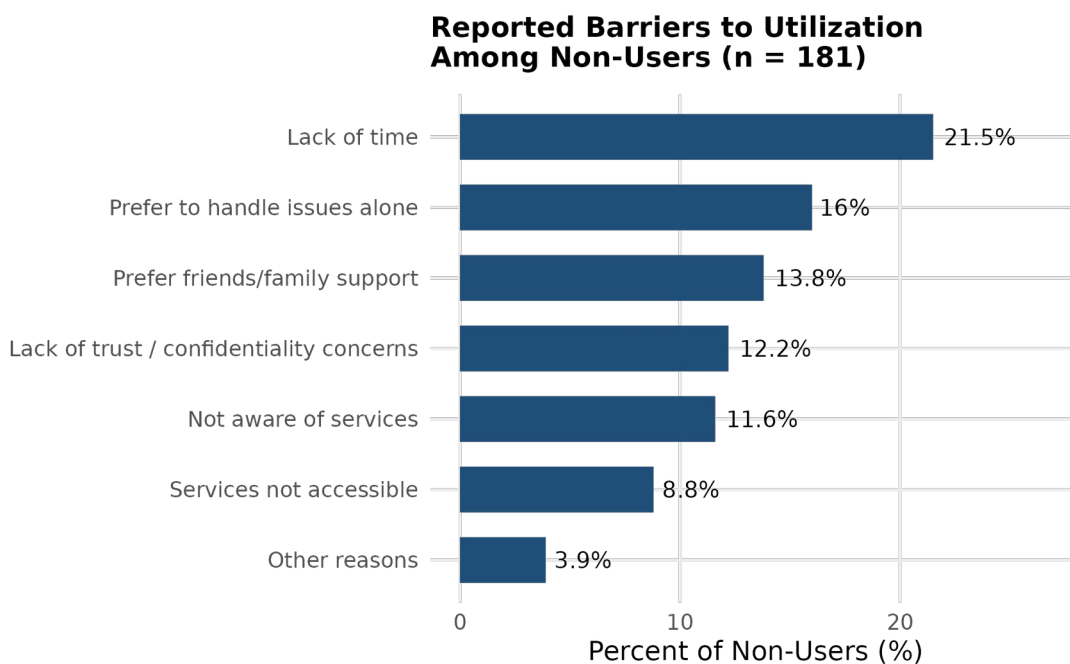
#### **4.6 Effect of Perceptions and Other Factors on Utilization**

The third research question examined how students' perceptions, including stigma, confidentiality, and accessibility, affect utilization of counselling services. Because the survey instrument applied skip logic, perceived barriers were recorded only for the 181 students who had never used counselling services. Table 4.5 presents the frequency with which each barrier was cited.

**Table 4.5***Reported Barriers to Utilization Among Non-Users (n = 181)*

| <b>Barrier</b>                                    | <b>n</b> | <b>Percent (%)</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| Lack of time                                      | 39       | 21.5               |
| Preference to handle issues alone (self-reliance) | 29       | 16                 |
| Preference for friends/family support             | 25       | 13.8               |
| Lack of trust / confidentiality concerns          | 22       | 12.2               |
| Not aware of the services                         | 21       | 11.6               |
| Services perceived as not accessible              | 16       | 8.8                |
| Other reasons                                     | 7        | 3.9                |

Percentages do not sum to 100% because respondents could select more than one barrier.

**Figure 4.3: Reported Barriers to Utilization Among Non-Users**

Lack of time (21.5%) was the most frequently cited barrier, followed by a preference to handle problems alone (16.0%) and a preference for informal support from friends or family (13.8%). Confidentiality and trust concerns were cited by 12.2% of non-users, while limited accessibility of services was cited by 8.8%. The prominence of self-reliance and informal-support preferences is consistent with self-stigma mechanisms described by Corrigan (2004) and Eisenberg et al. (2009),

whereby students avoid formal counselling not necessarily because they are unaware of it, but because of internalized reluctance to be seen as needing help. The presence of confidentiality concerns also corroborates findings by Otieno and Simiyu (2020) and Rushahu (2023) on the importance of privacy assurances for service uptake in Tanzanian university settings.

To further assess the joint effect of awareness and gender on the odds of utilization, a multivariate binary logistic regression was estimated. Year of study was excluded from this model because the first-year cell contained only two respondents, both non-users, which produced quasi-complete separation and unstable estimates; demographic differences by year were already addressed in Section 4.5.

**Table 4.6**

*Logistic Regression of Utilization on Awareness Score and Gender*

| Predictor                | Coefficient (B) | Odds Ratio | p-value |
|--------------------------|-----------------|------------|---------|
| Constant                 | -3.59           | 0.03       | 0.04    |
| Awareness Score          | 0.21            | 1.23       | 0.67    |
| Gender (Male vs. Female) | 0.84            | 2.31       | 0.2     |

Neither predictor was statistically significant at  $\alpha = 0.05$ .

Holding gender constant, a one point increase in the composite awareness score was associated with 23% higher odds of utilization (OR = 1.23), and being male was associated with more than double the odds of utilization relative to being female (OR = 2.31); however, neither effect was statistically significant ( $p = 0.665$  and  $p = 0.198$ , respectively). The wide confidence intervals implied by these results are a direct consequence of the very small number of students who had used the service ( $n = 19$ ), which limits the precision of the estimated odds ratios. Taken together with the descriptive barrier analysis, the findings suggest that utilization in this sample is driven more by practical and attitudinal barriers, such as time constraints and a preference for self-reliance or informal support, than by awareness or demographic characteristics alone.

#### **4.7 Discussion of Findings**

The findings of this study reveal a clear awareness-utilization gap: although the majority of students (85.5%) are aware of counselling services and report a moderate average level of awareness ( $M = 3.23$  out of 5), only a small fraction (9.5%) have ever utilized them. This gap is consistent with the



conceptual framework outlined in Chapter Two, which holds that awareness is a necessary but insufficient condition for help-seeking behavior (Gulliver et al., 2010).

With regard to the first research question, the Chi-square test and the logistic model both indicate that the association between awareness level and utilization, while in the expected direction (higher awareness associated with somewhat higher utilization), is not statistically significant in this sample. This should be interpreted cautiously rather than as evidence that awareness is irrelevant: the test has limited statistical power because only 19 of the 200 respondents had ever used the service.

Regarding the second research question, awareness does not differ significantly by gender or year of study, suggesting that informational interventions can be designed and delivered uniformly across these groups rather than being demographically targeted.

On the third research question, the descriptive analysis of barriers and the multivariate logistic model jointly suggest that utilization is shaped less by who students are (gender) or how much they know (awareness) and more by situational and attitudinal factors: limited time, a preference for self-reliance, reliance on informal support networks, and lingering concerns about trust and confidentiality. These results align closely with prior empirical work in similar settings (Eisenberg et al., 2007, 2009; Otieno & Simiyu, 2020; Rushahu, 2023) and reinforce the conclusion that improving awareness campaigns alone is unlikely to substantially increase utilization unless accompanied by measures that directly address these structural and psychological barriers.

#### **4.8 Chapter Summary**

This chapter has presented the demographic profile of the 200 student respondents and analyzed the relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services, demographic differences in awareness, and the factors influencing utilization. The key finding is a substantial awareness-utilization gap, with statistically non-significant associations between awareness, demographic characteristics, and utilization, alongside clear descriptive evidence that practical (time) and attitudinal (self-reliance, confidentiality concerns) barriers are the dominant reasons students do not use counselling services. The next chapter summarizes these findings, draws conclusions, and proposes recommendations.

## **5. CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS**

### **5.1 Introduction**

This chapter presents the conclusion drawn from the findings of the study on the awareness and utilization of counselling services among students at the University of Dar es Salaam. It also provides recommendations based on the study findings and suggests areas for future research.

### **5.2 Conclusion**

The purpose of this study was to assess students' awareness and utilization of counselling services at the University of Dar es Salaam and to determine whether awareness, demographic characteristics, and students' perceptions influence the utilization of these services.

The findings indicate that although a large majority of students (85.5%) were aware of the existence of counselling services, only 9.5% had ever utilized them. This demonstrates a substantial gap between awareness and actual use of counselling services. While awareness is essential for service utilization, the study found that awareness alone does not necessarily translate into help-seeking behaviour.

The statistical analyses further revealed that there was no significant relationship between awareness and utilization of counselling services. Similarly, no statistically significant differences in awareness were observed across gender or year of study. These findings suggest that awareness levels are relatively uniform among students and that demographic characteristics are not major determinants of counselling service utilization within the study population.

The study also established that practical and psychological barriers play a greater role in influencing students' decisions to seek counselling. The most frequently reported barriers included lack of time, preference to solve problems independently, reliance on friends or family for emotional support, concerns about confidentiality, and limited trust in counselling services. These barriers appear to discourage students from seeking professional psychological support even when they are aware that such services exist.

Overall, the study concludes that increasing awareness alone is unlikely to substantially improve counselling service utilization. Instead, interventions should focus on addressing the practical, social, and psychological barriers that prevent students from accessing available counselling services.

### **5.3 Recommendations**

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations are proposed.

#### **5.3.1 Recommendations to the University of Dar es Salaam**

The University should strengthen awareness campaigns by moving beyond simply informing students about the existence of counselling services. Awareness programmes should explain the benefits of counselling, clarify the counselling process, and address common misconceptions that discourage help-seeking.

The University should also increase efforts to assure students of the confidentiality and privacy of counselling services. Clear communication regarding ethical standards and confidentiality policies may improve students' trust and willingness to seek professional assistance.

To address time constraints, counseling services should become more flexible by extending operating hours, introducing online appointment systems, and expanding virtual counselling sessions where appropriate. These measures would improve accessibility for students with busy academic schedules.

Furthermore, the University should integrate mental health education into orientation programmes, seminars, and student development activities so that students become familiar with available support services from the beginning of their academic journey.

#### **5.3.2 Recommendations to Counseling Service Providers**

Counsellors should actively engage students through outreach programmes, workshops, and peer education initiatives aimed at reducing stigma associated with seeking psychological support.

The counselling unit should collaborate with student organizations, colleges, and academic departments to promote positive attitudes toward mental health and encourage early help-seeking behaviour.

Regular evaluation of counselling services should also be conducted to identify students' needs and continuously improve service quality, accessibility, and responsiveness.

#### **5.3.3 Recommendations to Students**

Students should be encouraged to view counselling services as a normal and valuable resource for maintaining psychological well-being, managing academic stress, and addressing personal challenges rather than seeking help only during crises.

Peer leaders and student organizations can also play an important role in encouraging positive attitudes toward professional counselling and reducing misconceptions surrounding mental health services.

#### **5.4 Recommendations for Future Research**

Since this study employed convenience sampling and involved students from a single university, future studies should use probability sampling techniques and larger sample sizes to improve the generalization of findings.

Future research should also include multiple universities across Tanzania to determine whether the observed awareness-utilization gap exists in different institutional settings.

In addition, qualitative studies involving interviews or focus group discussions are recommended to gain deeper insights into students' attitudes, beliefs, and experiences regarding counseling services.

Finally, future studies may examine other factors influencing counselling service utilization, including mental health literacy, perceived stigma, cultural beliefs, previous counselling experiences, social support, and the availability of digital mental health services.

#### **5.5 Chapter Summary**

This chapter has presented the conclusions drawn from the study and provided recommendations for improving the utilization of counseling services among students at the University of Dar es Salaam. Although students generally demonstrated moderate to high awareness of counseling services, utilization remained very low. The findings indicate that practical constraints and psychological barriers, rather than awareness or demographic characteristics, are the primary factors limiting service utilization. Addressing these barriers through comprehensive awareness initiatives, enhanced accessibility, strengthened confidentiality, and stigma reduction strategies is likely to improve students' willingness to seek professional counselling services and ultimately contribute to better mental health and academic success.

## REFERENCES

- Auerbach, R. P., Alonso, J., Axinn, W. G., et al. (2016). *Mental disorders among college students in the World Health Organization World Mental Health Surveys*. *Psychological Medicine*, 46(14), 2955–2970. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291716001665>
- Corrigan, P. W.. (2004). How stigma interferes with mental health care. *American Psychologist*, 59(7), 614–625. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066X.59.7.614>
- Eisenberg, D., Golberstein, E., & Gollust, S. E.. (2007). Help-seeking and access to mental health care in a university student population. *Medical Care*, 45(7), 594–601. <https://doi.org/10.1097/MLR.0b013e31803bb4c1>
- Eisenberg, D., Downs, M. F., & Golberstein, E.. (2009). Stigma and help seeking for mental health among college students. *Medical Care Research and Review*, 66(5), 522–541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1077558709335173>
- Gulliver, A., Griffiths, K. M., & Christensen, H.. (2010). Perceived barriers and facilitators to mental health help-seeking in young people: A systematic review. *BMC Psychiatry*, 10, Article 113. <https://doi.org/10.1186/1471-244X-10-113>
- Jorm, A. F., Korten, A. E., Jacomb, P. A., et al. (2000). Mental health literacy: A survey of the public's ability to recognise mental disorders and their beliefs about the effectiveness of treatment. *Medical Journal of Australia*, 166(4), 182–186.
- Kalonge, B. M. (2007). The provision of students counselling services at the University of Dar es salaam in the context of university of Dar es salaam transformation program. *University of Dar es Salaam, Tanzania*.
- Lasode, A. O., Lawal, O. O., & Ofodile, M. C. (2017). Students' need for, awareness, perception and use of guidance and counselling services in Federal University of Agriculture, Abeokuta, Nigeria. *Problems of Education in the 21st Century*, 75(2), 170.
- Otieno, J. O., & Mbutitia, F. (2020). Hindrances to the effective delivery of guidance and counselling services in mitigating psychosocial distress in Tanzanian universities. *International Journal of Education and Social Science Research*, 3(6), 195-203.
- Reavley, N. J., McCann, T. V., & Jorm, A. F.. (2012). Mental health literacy in higher education students. *Early Intervention in Psychiatry*, 6(1), 45–52. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1751-7893.2011.00314.x>
- Rickwood, D., Deane, F. P., Wilson, C. J., & Ciarrochi, J.. (2005). Young people's help-seeking for mental health problems. *Australian e-Journal for the Advancement of Mental Health*, 4(3), 218–251.
- Rushahu, B. G. (2023). The Need of Online Counselling to Enhance Mental Health among Students in Higher Learning Institutions in Tanzania. *Tanzania Journal of Sociology*, 9(2), 68-83.
- World Health Organization. (2022). *World mental health report: Transforming mental health for all*. World Health Organization.

## APPENDIX I: RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE

### RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE

**Research Title: Statistical Analysis of the Awareness and Utilization of Counselling Services among Students at the University of Dar es Salaam**

#### Introduction

Dear Respondent,

We are undergraduate students pursuing a Bachelor of Science in Mathematical Statistics (BSMST) at the University of Dar es Salaam. We are conducting this study to assess students' awareness and utilization of counselling services at the University of Dar es Salaam.

Your participation is entirely voluntary. All information provided will be treated with strict confidentiality and used solely for academic purposes. Please answer all questions honestly by ticking the appropriate response.

Thank you for your valuable participation.

#### SECTION A: DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

##### 1. Gender

☐ Male

☐ Female

##### 2. Age Group

☐ Below 20 years

☐ 20–24 years

☐ Above 24 years

##### 3. Year of Study

☐ First Year

☐ Second Year

☐ Third Year

☐ Fourth Year or Above

##### 4. College

☐ CoNAS

☐ COET

☐ COICT

☐ UDBS

- ☐ UDSE
- ☐ COSS
- ☐ COAF
- ☐ Other (Specify): \_\_\_\_\_

## SECTION B: AWARENESS OF COUNSELLING SERVICES

Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements.

| Statement                                                                             | Strongly<br>Disagree<br>(1) | Disagree<br>(2)          | Neutral (3)              | Agree (4)                | Strongly<br>Agree (5)    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. I know that counselling services are available at the University of Dar es Salaam. | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2. I know where counselling services are located.                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3. I understand the types of services offered by the counselling unit.                | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4. I know the benefits of using counselling services.                                 | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5. The University provides sufficient information about counselling services.         | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## SECTION C: UTILIZATION OF COUNSELLING SERVICES

**1. Have you ever used counselling services provided by the University?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

**If YES, answer Questions 2 and 3.**

**2. How many times have you used the counselling services?**

- ☐ Once
- ☐ Two to three times
- ☐ More than three times

**3. Overall, how satisfied were you with the counselling services?**

- ☐ Very Dissatisfied
- ☐ Dissatisfied
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Satisfied
- ☐ Very Satisfied

#### SECTION D: BARRIERS TO UTILIZATION

*(Answer this section ONLY if you answered “No” to Section C Question 1.)*

**What are the reasons you have never used counselling services?** *(Tick all that apply.)*

- ☐ I do not have enough time.
- ☐ I prefer solving my problems on my own.
- ☐ I prefer seeking support from friends or family.
- ☐ I am concerned about confidentiality.
- ☐ I do not know enough about the counselling services.
- ☐ Counselling services are not easily accessible.
- ☐ I do not think I need counselling.
- ☐ Other (Specify): \_\_\_\_\_

#### SECTION E: PERCEPTIONS TOWARD COUNSELLING SERVICES

Please indicate your level of agreement.

| Statement                                                          | Strongly<br>Disagree<br>(1) | Disagree<br>(2)          | Neutral (3)              | Agree (4)                | Strongly<br>Agree (5)    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Counselling services are confidential.                          | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2. I trust counsellors to protect students' privacy.               | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3. Students who seek counselling are sometimes stigmatized.        | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4. Seeking counselling is a sign of strength rather than weakness. | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5. Counselling services are easily accessible to                   | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |



| Statement                                                    | Strongly<br>Disagree<br>(1) | Disagree<br>(2)          | Neutral (3)              | Agree (4)                | Strongly<br>Agree (5)    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| students.                                                    |                             |                          |                          |                          |                          |
| 6. I would recommend counselling services to other students. | <input type="checkbox"/>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

### **Thank You**

Thank you for taking your time to complete this questionnaire. Your responses are highly appreciated and will contribute significantly to this research.